

FACTORS TO CONSIDER WHEN CHOOSING CHIDCARE

- **Attitude/Energy**

Is the staff warm and welcoming? Do they pay individual attention to each child? When you walk in the facility, is it total chaos when you walk in? Children will thrive in an environment that is controlled, engaging and supportive.

- **Recommendations by Others**

One of the best ways to measure the quality of a childcare center is by asking other parents for a referral. Also, when you are visiting a center, talk to parents of children who are ready enrolled. Ask about the experience their children are having and if they are satisfied with the quality of service.

- **Communication**

How does the staff communicate with parents about what is going? How will they report to you about any problems they are having? Do they encourage feedback from parents? How would they like to receive feedback? Open communication can help improve your child's overall experience.

- **Training, Licensing, Credentials and Accreditation**

A well-educated and experienced staff will provide high quality interactions and activities for your child. Make sure to ask the following questions when looking at a childcare center:

- ✓ Does the director have experience caring for children?
- ✓ Who is on staff? Is there a place to view staff biographies?
- ✓ How is the staff screened?
- ✓ Does each staff member have the right credentials and experience?
- ✓ Does someone have current CPR and first aid training?
- ✓ How does the childcare center conduct its own training on an ongoing basis?
- ✓ Does the staff continue to receive training about the changes in childcare industry?
- ✓ What type of accreditation have you received?

- **The Facility**



Make sure to inspect the layout of the facility for cleanliness and organization. Is the layout open for children to play and crawl? Also, look for cleanliness and ask about the daily cleaning routine. You can check for health inspection results using local government websites.

- **Staff Turnover**



High staff turnover can negatively affect your child. The constant turnover of staff members interrupts a child's schedule and routine. Building a trusting relationship with someone and having consistency helps make a child's day go much easier.

- **Curriculum**

Familiarize yourself with each childcare center's curriculum. Ask each center how it prepares children for school. Ask about the reasoning behind the chosen curriculum and its advantages. Compare the different curriculums to each other and decide which one would benefit your child the most. The time your child spends each day at the childcare center will help to establish a foundation for learning.



- **Daily Schedule**

What does a typical day look like? What types of activities will your child participate in? Is a daily schedule available for parents? Getting an idea of the daily schedule will help you determine whether your child will enjoy his or her day.

- **Location**

Is the location convenient for you? Is there plenty of parking? It is in a safe area?



CHILD DEVELOPMENT

Development is about how things change over time. **Child development** is about how children grow and learn as they get older. All children are different and learn to do things at different ages. How quickly children learn something is called their rate of development.

For example, some children learn to walk before their first birthday and some children learn to walk much later.

Each child's rate of **development** is different, but children across the world seem to learn things in the same order – children learn to walk before they learn to run.

So how do children learn? They learn by:

- Watching people and things around them
- Copying other children and their family
- Doing and trying things out for themselves

A child's development is affected by things such as:

- What a child eats
- If the child is healthy and safe
- Knowing that they are loved by their family.

THE DOMAINS OF DEVELOPMENT



Child development has many parts - each part is called a **domain of development**.

The domains of development that you will learn about in this program are:

1. **Physical development**
2. **Social development**
3. **Emotional development**
4. **Cognitive development**
5. **Language development**

For every child, all the domains of development – physical, social, emotional, cognitive and language – develop together. One part (one domain) can't develop without the others and if one part is slow to develop it will affect all the other parts of the child's development.

For example, if a child is slow to talk (language development) then it may affect their ability to make friends and play games with other children (social development) which may affect how they feel about themselves (emotional development)

A child's development is holistic. This means that a child's learning and development happens when all the domains of development work together. It also means that many play activities provide opportunities for children to develop across many domains of development at the same time.





Physical development is about what a child can do with their body – how they learn to do activities using their arms, legs, hands, feet, fingers, toes, lips etc.

Physical development has two types of skills - **gross motor skills** and **fine motor skills**. Motor skills are to do with the movements of your body. Gross means ‘big’ or ‘large’ so gross motor skills are skills developed through activities using the big muscles of the body *for example, Running and jumping use the muscles in your legs*. kids also learn to use their larger muscles, like those in their arms, legs, back, and stomach. Walking, running, throwing, lifting, pulling, pushing, and kicking are all important skills that are related to body awareness, balance, and strength. These skills allow your child to control and move their body in different ways

Fine means ‘small’ or ‘little’ so **fine motor skills** are skills developed through activities using the small muscles of the body, *for example drawing, painting, threading and cutting use the small muscles in your hand*. These fine motor skills help kids perform tasks for daily living, like buttoning buttons, picking up finger foods, using a fork, pouring milk, going to the restroom, and washing their hands.

LIST OF ACTIVITIES TO PROMOTE MOTORIC SKILL DEVELOPMENT

Jumping rope	Filling and emptying containers
Playing hopscotch	Stacking and arranging, beads
Tossing and catching balls of different sizes	Puzzles with varying size handles
Pitching bean bags	Encourage children to turn the pages of a book
Climbing in many different directions	
Pedaling riding toys	
Pulling wagons or toys	
Pushing toy strollers or brooms	

STATUS OF MOTOR SKILLS DEVELOPMENT BY AGE CATEGORY

AGE CATEGORY	STATUS OF MOTOR SKILLS DEVELOPMENT
Infants (4 months)	• Can lift their head and chest when lying on stomach. • Hold both eyes in a fixed position. • Follow a moving object or person with their eyes. • Grab and hold onto a rattle or your finger. • Wiggle and kick with arms and legs. • Roll from stomach to back. • Sit up, but only with support.
8 Months	• Roll from back to stomach and stomach to back. • Sit alone without support. • Raise up on arms and knees into crawling position. • Rock back and forth on hands and knees, but may or may not move forward. • Use the finger and thumb to pick up objects. • Transfer objects from one hand to the other.

12 Months	• Enjoy opening and closing cabinet doors. • Crawl well and can move very quickly by crawling. • Pull themselves to a standing position. • Stand alone and walk while holding on to furniture for support. • Might take a few steps alone.
Toddlers 12-18 Months	• Stand alone, sit down and move while holding on to furniture. • Begin walking and become more confident with experience. • Gesture or point to objects to indicate what they want. • Push and pull objects, including strollers, wagons, push toys and even furniture. • Fill and dump containers. • Pull off their hat, socks and mittens. • Turn pages in a board book. • Stack blocks. • poke, twist and squeeze objects. • Flush toilets and close doors. • Carry small objects while walking, often one in each hand. • Hold a crayon and scribble but have difficulty controlling the scribbling. • Wave bye-bye and clap their hands. • Pick up small finger foods and eat them.

	• Hold a spoon when eating but may have trouble • getting the spoon into their mouths. • Roll a ball to an adult when asked.
18-24 Months	• Walk well. • Run but can't always stop or turn well. • Drink from a straw and feed themselves with a spoon. • Wash their hands. • Stack more blocks and knock down block towers. • Toss or roll a large ball. • Bend over to pick up toys without falling. • Walk up steps with help. • Take a few steps backward. • Move small-wheeled riding toys with their feet. • Have some control of their bowels and bladder.
24-36 Months	• Walk up and down stairs by holding onto the railing. • Climb stairs with both feet on each step. • Feed themselves with a spoon or fork easily. • Experiment by touching, smelling and tasting objects. • Push, pull, fill and dump. • Fit objects into small spaces. • Turn pages of a picture book but may need to be reminded to turn them gently. • Stack four to six blocks or other objects. • Control scribbles made with crayons or markers. • Learn to use the toilet. • Walk backwards, and jump with both feet.

	• Toss or roll a large ball. • Catch a ball with both arms extended. • Squat down and can stand up from a squatting position without falling.
Pre-Scholars 3yrs	• Use the toilet with some help • put their shoes on but cannot tie laces. • Dress themselves but may need some help with buttons, snaps and zippers. • Feed themselves but may spill occasionally. • Catch a large ball with both arms. • Throw a ball overhead. • Kick a ball forward. • Hop on one foot. • Walk a short distance on tiptoe. • Climb up and down a small slide by themselves. • Pedal a tricycle.
4yrs	• Dress themselves without much help. • Use a spoon, fork and dinner knife skillfully. • Walks a straight line. • Hop on one foot. • Pedals and steers a tricycle skillfully. • Jump over objects 6-5 inches high. • Run, jump, hop, skip around obstacles with ease. • Stack 10 or more blocks. • Form shapes and objects out of clay or play dough.
5yrs	• Dress themselves with little assistance. • Skip. • Throw a ball overhead.

	• Catch bounced balls. • Ride a tricycle skillfully and may show interest in riding a bicycle with training wheels. • Cut on a line with scissors. • Use a dominant hand consistently. • Jump over low objects.
6yrs- 8yrs	• Tests muscle strength. • Has good sense of balance. • Is good at coordinating both sides of the body. • Develops a quicker reaction time. • Uses scissors and small tools with confidence. • Ties their shoelaces. • Enjoys copying designs and shapes, letters and numbers. • Writes with confidence. • Uses both print and cursive writing if taught.

This domain involves the senses (taste, touch, sight, smell, hearing, and proprioception — or bodily awareness of one's orientation in space. Humans develop physical ability directionally, from top to bottom and the center outward. A baby will at first have the ability to turn the head and sit upright, before being able to reach, grab, and eventually walk and run as they progress into toddlerhood (2-3 years). All the while child should be able to instinctively respond and react to stimuli in his or her physical environment.

Caregivers can help a child's physical development by providing opportunities for age-appropriate activities. For instance, babies need **regular tummy** time to build their **neck and upper body strength**, while preschoolers and school-aged children need plenty of opportunities to **run around and play**. Even teens need regular opportunities for physical activity.

Meanwhile, you shouldn't overlook a child's need to develop their fine motor skills as well. From an early age, give them opportunities to use their hands and fingers. Give them rattles, plush balls, and other toys to grasp.

Later, toys that allow them to pick things up and fit them into slots are good for developing beginning skills. As they get older, teach them how to **button buttons**, use **scissors**, hold a **pencil**, and do other tasks with their fingers and hands.

Physical development also can be influenced by nutrition and illness. So, make sure kids have a **healthy diet** and **regular wellness check-ups** in order to promote proper **child development**.

